1 · Problem

Young people here have talent, but no power or connection

- Phones and lamps go dead: charging is costly and queues are long
- Little internet access, so online learning and work stay out of reach
- Youth want skills and income but have few places to start
- In Hagadera, many young people finish school with no way to earn

2 · Solution

SolarLink: a solar charging and digital skills hub

- Affordable solar phone and lamp charging
- Low-cost internet and a quiet study space
- Short digital skills classes taught by trained youth
- Income for the community, clean power for everyone

Thousands of customers within walking distance

- Target: youth and families in Hagadera and nearby blocks
- Estimated 10,000 people within a 15-minute walk
- Estimated 2,000 households needing charging every week
- Growth: other blocks, schools and youth centers

What a customer gets

- Charging station: 20 ports, solar panel and battery
- Wi-Fi and 6 study desks
- Weekly classes: phone skills, typing, online work basics
- Simple payment: cash, punch card or mobile money

5 · Business Model

How SolarLink earns

- Charging: KES 20 per phone charge
- Internet and study desk: KES 20 per hour
- Classes: KES 300 per month per learner
- Grants and sponsors to fund free places for girls and low-income youth

Early plan and milestones

- Month 1: survey 30 neighbors about charging and internet needs
- Month 2: run a 2-week pilot with 1 panel and 10 ports
- Goal: 100 paying customers in the first month
- Goal: 20 learners enrolled in the first class

Why people will choose SolarLink

- Competitors: generator charging shops and small kiosks
- They are costly, noisy and offer only charging
- SolarLink is clean, cheaper and teaches skills
- A local team that knows the community

How we reach customers

- Start with one location and friends and family
- Word of mouth, posters and community leaders
- Free first-class day to bring people in
- Partner with schools and youth groups

Who is building this

- Warsan: founder, leads the plan, customers and community
- Technician: solar setup and repairs (to recruit)
- Teaching lead: digital skills classes (to recruit)
- Mentor: local business or NGO advisor (to find)

Simple estimates for the first year

- Startup cost: KES 150,000 (solar kit, ports, desks, router)
- Monthly costs: about KES 16,000 (data, repairs, helpers)
- Monthly income goal: about KES 32,000
- Break-even on startup cost: around month 10

What we need to launch

- Funding: KES 150,000 (about USD 1,150)
- Use: solar equipment 60%, internet 20%, training 20%
- Mentorship in business and technical skills
- Introductions to partners and customers

Power and skills for every young person

- Year 1: one hub running and profitable
- Year 3: 3 hubs and 500 youth trained
- Long term: a youth-led network of clean energy and skills centers